



Presented by The High End



CASTLE FORTRESS ALPHA

Full-Size Cardboard Castle with Towers, Battlements & Gatehouse

Build a real castle. With towers. And battlements. And an arch you walk through.

AGES
4–12

BOXES
5–7 Large Boxes

TIME
3–4 Hours

DIFF
Advanced ***

PIECES
5 pcs

CARDBOARD NEEDED:

5–7 Large Boxes (at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm) each)

MISSION GOAL:

Build a castle: walk-through gatehouse arch, 2 gatehouse towers, 2 corner towers, side walls, crenellated battlements on all surfaces.



GATEHOUSE TOWER PANEL

18" x 30" (46 x 76 cm) | Cut x4

CUT
x4

GATEHOUSE TOWER PANEL

x4

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:
Along the top edge mark 5 alternating blocks of about 3.6". Cut 3" DOWN into every second block, leaving the first and last standing.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

18" x 30" (46 x 76 cm)
Battlements along the top edge

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.	FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line
--	--

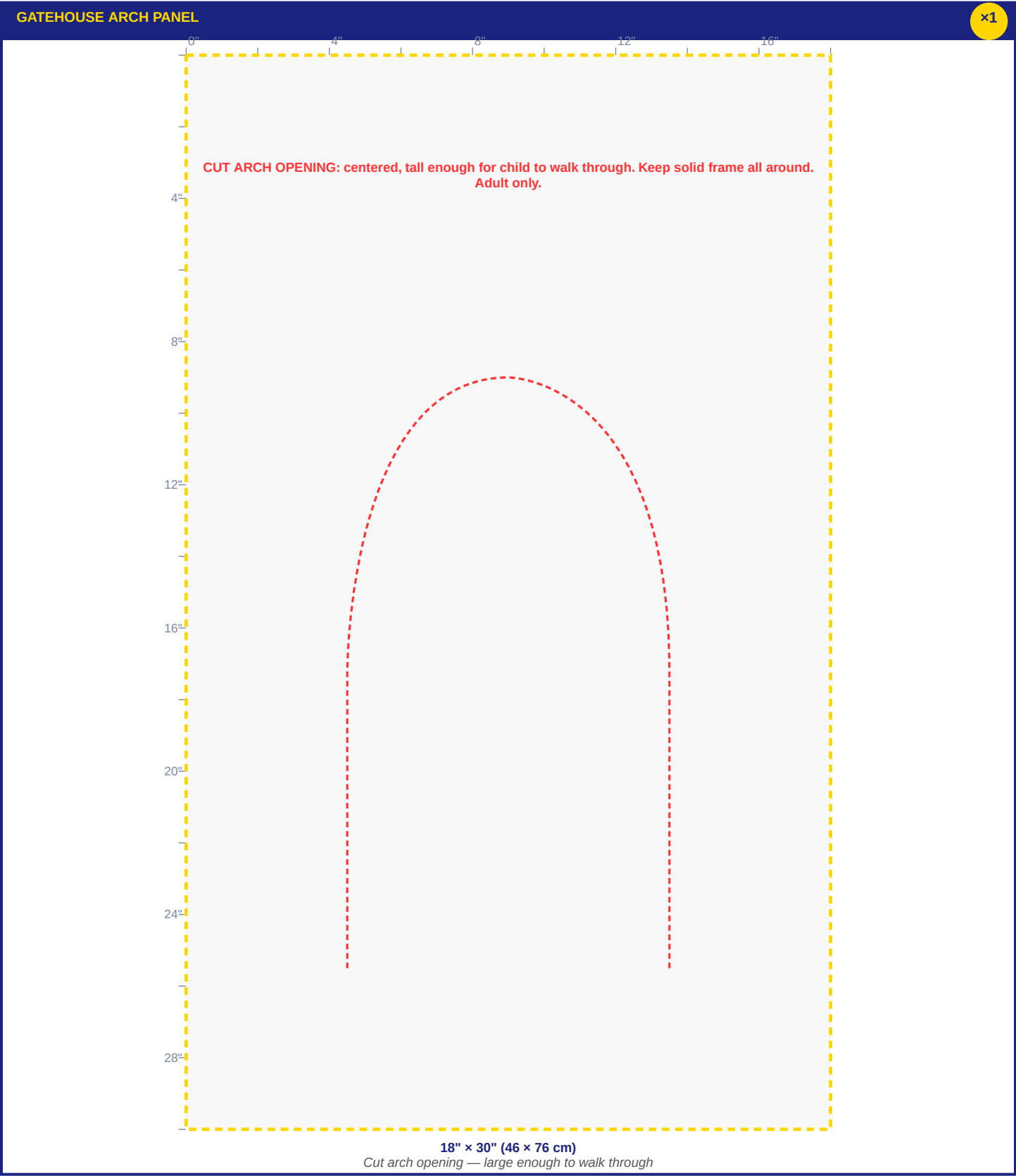
NOTE: 2 panels per tower — tape at 90° corner



GATEHOUSE ARCH PANEL

18" x 30" (46 x 76 cm) | Cut x1

CUT
x1



MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

ARCH — cut a curved arch opening as shown

NOTE: Cut arch opening — large enough to walk through



SIDE WALL PANEL

24" × 20" (61 × 51 cm) | Cut ×4

CUT
x4

SIDE WALL PANEL

x4

0" 4" 8" 12" 16" 20"

4" 8" 12" 16" 20"

16" 12" 8" 4" 0"

24" × 20" (61 × 51 cm)
Battlements along the top edge

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:

Along the top edge mark 7 alternating blocks of about 3.4". Cut 3" DOWN into every second block, leaving the first and last standing.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.	FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line
--	--

NOTE: 2 walls on each side of gatehouse



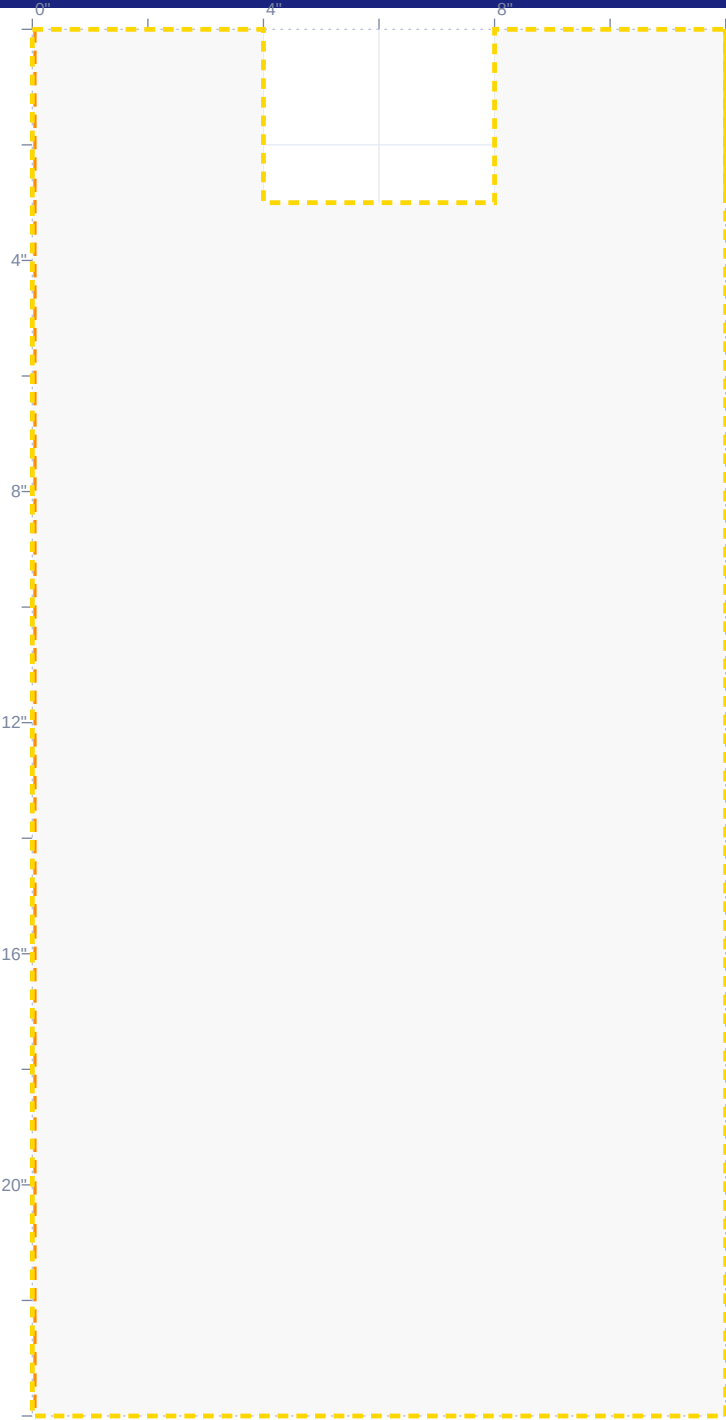
CORNER TOWER PANEL

12" x 24" (30 x 61 cm) | Cut x4

CUT
x4

CORNER TOWER PANEL

x4



HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:

Along the top edge mark 3 alternating blocks of about 4". Cut 3" DOWN into every second block, leaving the first and last standing.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

12" x 24" (30 x 61 cm)
Battlements along the top edge

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.	FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line
--	--

NOTE: 2 panels per corner tower — tape at 90°



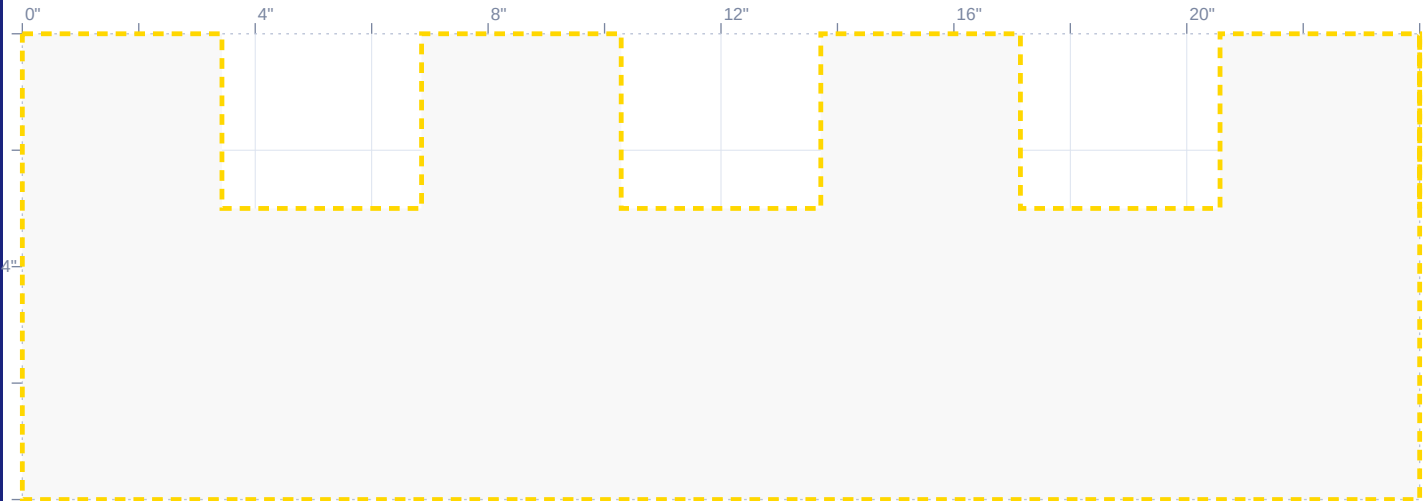
BATTLEMENT STRIP

24" × 8" (61 × 20 cm) | Cut ×6

CUT
x6

BATTLEMENT STRIP

×6



HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:

Along the top edge mark 7 alternating blocks of about 3.4". Cut 3" DOWN into every second block, leaving the first and last standing.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

24" × 8" (61 × 20 cm)

Battlement strip — notches all the way across

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

NOTE: Cut alternating notches across top

WHAT YOU NEED — CASTLE FORTRESS ALPHA

CARDBOARD PIECES — 5 TOTAL (5–7 Large Boxes (at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm) each))

×4

Gatehouse Tower Panel

18" × 30"

2 panels per tower — tape at 90° corner

×1

Gatehouse Arch Panel

18" × 30"

Cut arch opening — large enough to walk through

×4

Side Wall Panel

24" × 20"

2 walls on each side of gatehouse

×4

Corner Tower Panel

12" × 24"

2 panels per corner tower — tape at 90°

×6

Battlement Strip

24" × 8"

Cut alternating notches across top

TOOLS & SUPPLIES

+ 5–7 large cardboard boxes

+ Box cutter — ADULT USE ONLY

+ Packing tape (3+ rolls)

+ GREY PAINT — entire castle is grey stone

+ Black marker for stone block pattern (horizontal + offset vertical lines)

+ Moss green paint for base

FUN FACT!

The oldest castle still standing was built in 963 AD — over 1,000 years ago. Let's see how long yours lasts.

CHALLENGE!

Siege time! One defender inside with foam balls to throw, attackers outside. Castle must survive 3 rounds.

1

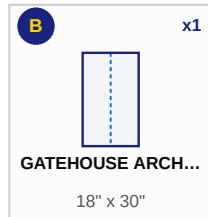
STEP 1: BUILD THE GATEHOUSE ARCH

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Take the Gatehouse Arch Panel. Using the (arch) arch mark on the template, cut a large arch opening in the center. The arch must be tall enough for a child to walk through comfortably. Keep solid cardboard frame on all sides of the arch.

SAFETY: Adult cuts the arch only. Smooth curved top — no jagged edges inside the arch.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



2

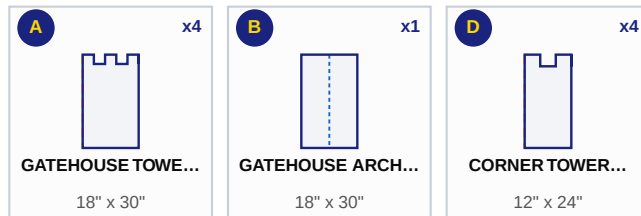
STEP 2: BUILD THE TWO GATEHOUSE TOWERS

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

For each tower: take 2 Tower Panels and tape them at a 90° corner (corner edge mark on template). The tower L-shapes attach to each side of the arch panel. Towers must be taller than the arch center.

SAFETY: Two people needed to hold tower panels at 90° while taping the corner.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



3

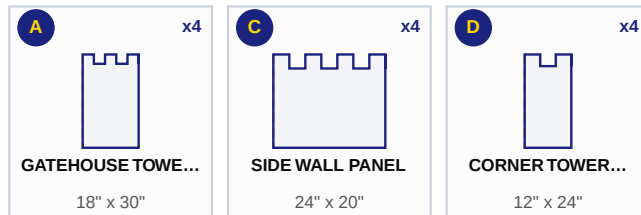
STEP 3: CUT CRENELLATIONS

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Use the notch marks on the template as your guide. Cut alternating rectangular notches across the tops of ALL tower panels and wall panels — each notch 4" (10 cm) wide x 3" (8 cm) tall. These are the battlements. Every surface gets them.

SAFETY: Adult cuts notches on all pieces. Mark all notches with pencil first.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



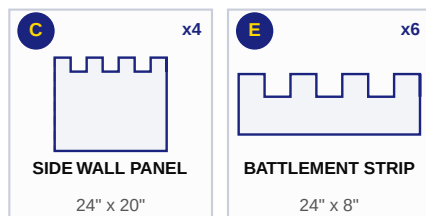
4

STEP 4: ADD SIDE WALLS

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Tape 2 Side Wall Panels to each side of the gatehouse structure (inner edge marks). Walls extend outward from the towers and are lower than the towers. Add battlement strips along all wall tops.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

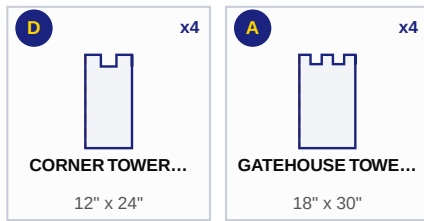


5

STEP 5: BUILD CORNER TOWERS

At the far ends of both side walls, build 2 corner towers using 2 Corner Tower Panels each (same 90° L-shape, corner edge marks). Smaller than the gatehouse towers. Add battlement notches on top.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



6

STEP 6: DRAW THE STONE PATTERN

THIS IS THE MOST IMPORTANT STEP. On ALL surfaces: draw horizontal lines every 2 inches. Then add short vertical lines offset from row to row — staggered brick pattern. Every wall, tower, and battlement. Do not skip any surface.

7

STEP 7: PAINT GREY

Paint all surfaces medium grey. Slightly vary shade in some areas for depth. The stone pattern under the grey is what makes it look real.

8

STEP 8: MOSS DETAILS

At the base of every wall and tower, add mossy green paint 2–3" (5–8 cm) up from the bottom. Real castle walls always have moss at the base.

9

STEP 9: QUALITY CHECK

Stand back and compare to cover photo. Arch walkable. Towers on both sides. Side walls extend outward. Corner towers at ends. Battlements on everything. Stone pattern. Grey paint. Matches the photo.

QUALITY CHECK!

Does your build match the cover photo? Compare side by side before you call it done.

"Build It. Own It." — Tatum & Kash Cardboard Creations